

Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Daniella Marie A. Leonud
Section / Class	BSIT-3G
Challenge Name	bytemancy 0
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	August 7, 2026
Flag Format Given	picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_62006ed0}

1. Challenge Description

Restate the challenge in your own words: what were you given, and what were you asked to find or do? Do not simply copy-paste the original prompt.

The challenge that was given to me is called **bytemancy 0**. In this challenge, I was asked to connect to a server using a netcat command and provide the correct input to receive the hidden flag. The challenge also provided a Python source code file, so I needed to check the code first to understand what kind of input the program was expecting.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

What did you check first? What did file, strings, a webpage view-source, or another first look tell you? What category did you decide this was, and why?

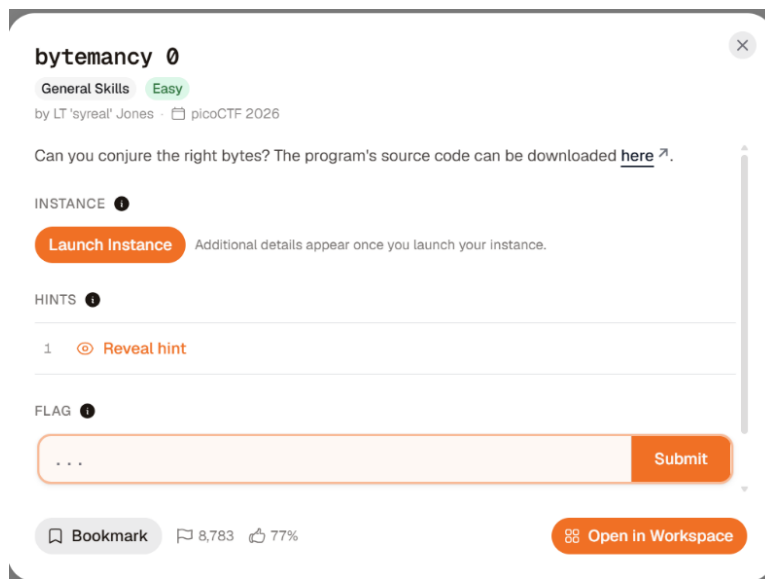
First, I downloaded the provided Python file called **app.py** to see how the code works. I opened the file in my browser to check what input it was asking for. Looking at the code, I noticed that the program was asking for **ASCII decimal 101 three times without spaces**. I didn't know what number 101 represented, so I searched for it, and I found out that **ASCII decimal 101** is the lowercase letter **e**. Since the program wanted 101 three times without spaces, then the answer should be **eee**.

4. Solution Walkthrough

Explain your reasoning step by step — not just what you typed, but why you tried it and what you concluded from the result. Include screenshots, code snippets, or command output where useful. A reader who has not seen the challenge should be able to follow your logic and arrive at the same answer.

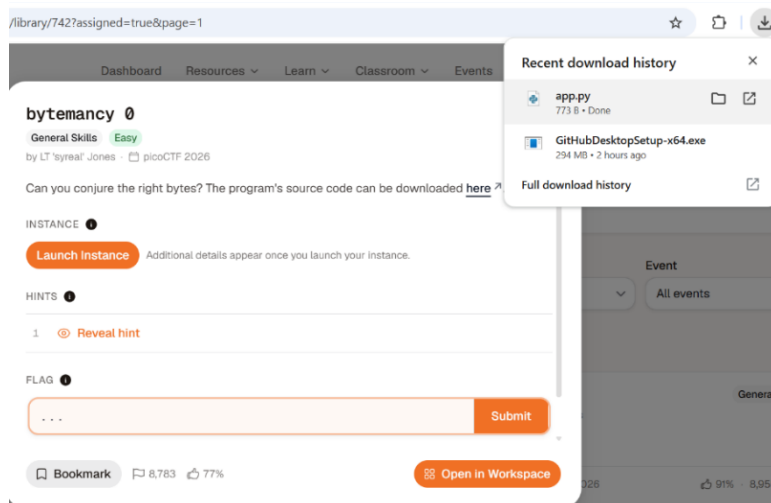
Step 1

The first step was to open the challenge and read the instructions and hint carefully. I noticed that the challenge provided a source code file that could be downloaded. I clicked the option to download the source code because I wanted to understand what the program was asking for before connecting to the server. I also launched the instance because this would give me the netcat address and port that I needed to connect to.



Step 2

After clicking the download option, the source code was automatically downloaded. The file was named **app.py**. I opened the file so I could read the Python code and understand what the challenge expected as an answer.



Step 3

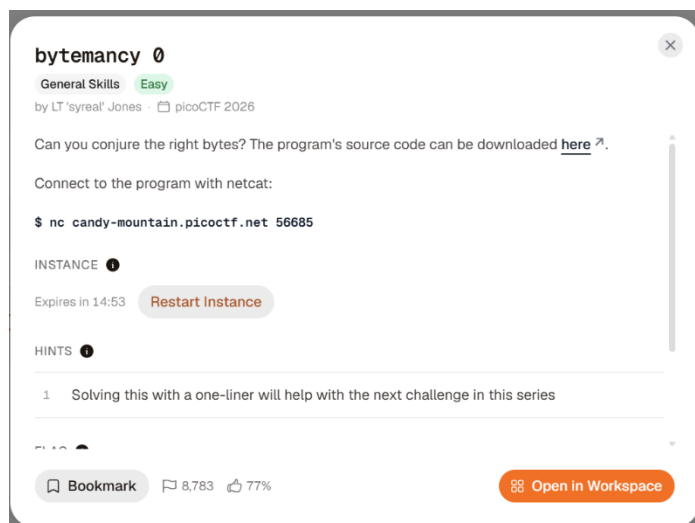
I opened the downloaded **app.py** file using Google Chrome. After looking through the code, I noticed that the program was asking for **ASCII decimal 101 three times without spaces**.

```
<  →  ↻  ⓘ File C:/Users/Administrator/Downloads/app.py

while(True):
    try:
        print('┌───[ BYTEMANCY-0 ]───┐')
        print("⌠⌡⌢⌣⌤⌥⌦⌧⌨〈〉⌫⌬⌭⌮⌯⌰⌱⌲⌳⌴⌵⌶⌷⌸⌹⌺⌻⌼⌽⌾⌿⌿")
        print()
        print('Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, no space.')
        print()
        print("⌠⌡⌢⌣⌤⌥⌦⌧⌨〈〉⌫⌬⌭⌮⌯⌰⌱⌲⌳⌴⌵⌶⌷⌸⌹⌺⌻⌼⌽⌾⌿⌿")
        print('└───┘')
        user_input = input('==> ')
        if user_input == "\x65\x65\x65":
            print(open("./flag.txt", "r").read())
            break
        else:
            print("That wasn't it. I got: " + str(user_input))
            print()
            print()
            print()
    except Exception as e:
        print(e)
        break
```

Step 4

After understanding what the source code was asking for, I clicked Launch Instance. The challenge gave me the following netcat command **nc candy-mountain.picoctf.net 56685** I copied this command and opened the workspace. Then I opened the terminal and pasted the command directly into it.



Step 5

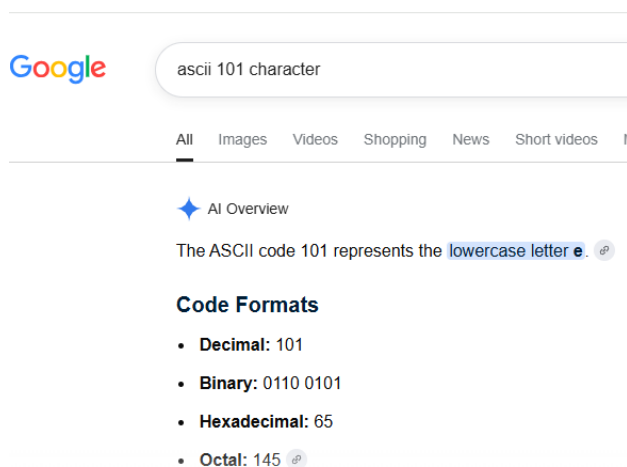
After connecting to the netcat server, I was given an interactive prompt that asked me for **ASCII DECIMAL 101, 101, 101 side by side, no space**. At first, I needed to determine what character the number 101 represented. I searched on Google for the ASCII character table and looked for decimal 101. The result showed that *ASCII decimal 101 = e*. This meant that every 101 in the prompt represented the lowercase letter **e**.

```
>_ Terminal  CyberChef  CTF Primer

=====
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~$ nc candy-mountain.picoctf.net 56685
+-----[ BYTEMANCY-0 ]-----+
  00G 0R000000G 0R000000G 0R000000G

Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, no space.

  00G 0R000000G 0R000000G 0R000000G
+-----+-----+-----+
==> |
```



Step 6

Since the ASCII character of 101 is the letter e, I entered **eee** as my answer. The program accepted it and printed the flag.

```
>_ Terminal  CyberChef  CTF Primer

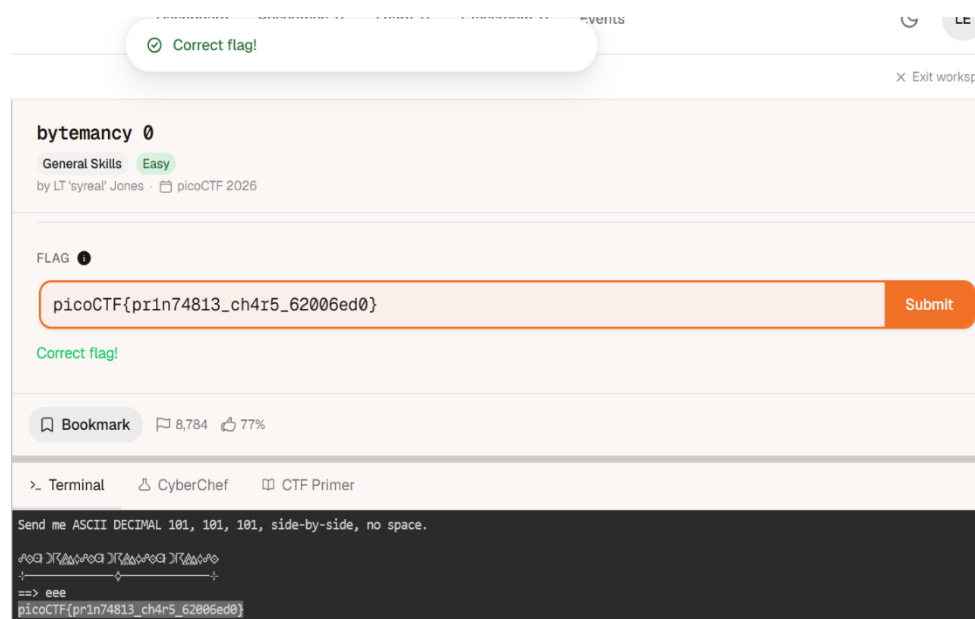
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~$ nc candy-mountain.picoctf.net 56685
+-----[ BYTEMANCY-0 ]-----+
  00G 0R000000G 0R000000G 0R000000G

Send me ASCII DECIMAL 101, 101, 101, side-by-side, no space.

  00G 0R000000G 0R000000G 0R000000G
+-----+-----+-----+
==> eee
picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_62006ed0}
```

Step 7

I copied the flag from the terminal, pasted it into the submission box on CyLab, and clicked submit. Since it says that the flag is correct, then that's it.



5. Flag

picoCTF{pr1n74813_ch4r5_62006ed0}

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

In 2-4 sentences, name the underlying security concept or vulnerability class this challenge taught (e.g. "weak RSA exponent," "reflected XSS," "stack buffer overflow"). This is the part of the write-up most worth remembering after the flag is submitted.

This challenge taught me about ASCII and character representation. I learned that computers can represent characters using numbers, and in this case, ASCII decimal 101 represents the lowercase letter e. I also learned that checking the source code first can make a challenge much easier because it can show what kind of input the program expects. Even though the answer looked like a number at first, understanding ASCII allowed me to convert it into the correct character.

7. References

List any external resource you consulted beyond course materials (a tool's documentation, a technique explainer, a similar public write-up). It is normal and expected to use references — just cite them.

ASCII Table Chart (<https://www.asciitable.com/>)

Google Search (<https://www.google.com>)
